

Service with a smile

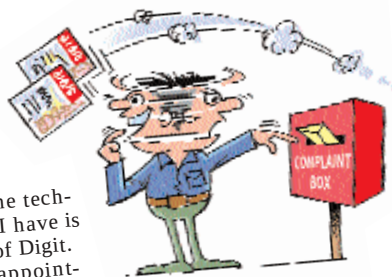
Hi! I work in the Merchant Navy, and after five months of exhausting tour-of-duty at sea, I recently came back eagerly waiting to feast my eyes on Digit. All the technology knowledge I have is primarily because of Digit. So imagine my disappointment when I realised that two issues sent to my residence had to be returned because there was no one at home.

I immediately wrote to Digit, explaining my problem. This time around, it was my turn to be delighted. I was mighty impressed that the two missing copies of Digit landed at my doorstep within 24 hours of my mail. How cool is that!

I know people sometimes do not have a good opinion about Digit's customer service, but hey, how much better can you get than this.

My special thanks go out to Reema at the Customer Service desk, and may your magazine succeed all the time. In the meanwhile, let me get back to my favourite pastime when I am home—reading Digit, and exploring the CDs.

Dilip D'Souza
Via e-mail



Dear Dilip,
Our customer service desk is always ready with solutions for our readers—be it subscription related queries, or defective or broken CDs. Please do not hesitate to get in touch with the customer service desk at help@jasubhai.com any time.

digit

Yes we have ESP

What can I say, but huge thanks for the February issue's Tips & Tricks section, which covered useful stuff for Web designers. That was a real help!

It was also good to read the review on *Gothic2*, the game. I am a big fan of *Gothic* or horror-based RPGs and there are not many that are publicised. I would love to play *Gothic1* before I go for the sequel.

Yuvan

Via e-mail

Hey guys, I have tried out 3ds max, Maya, Softimage Rhinoceros 3D and Cinema 4D. 3ds max 6 is really cool, especially the new architectural tools and integrated DX9 shader support in the material manager. Nice for us game developers.

I found Maya to be user-friendly, though the interface isn't as appealing as Max's at first glance. Maya has better features for nurbs and subdiv modelling, while Max would be the better choice for polygonal modelling.

You can find a trial version of Maya at www.alias.com (it's called PLE and is actually a free version of Maya). Maya was used in the making of *Final Fantasy: The Spirits Within* and *LOTR 3: Return of the King*.

Anidex

Via e-mail



Dear Yuvan and Anidex,

There is a treat awaiting you in this month's Tips and Tricks section—all of eight pages devoted to just Maya and 3DS Max. We have two of India's best professionals—Suzanne Rebello and Sachin Puthran—who have given some great tips for both these amazing software. Have fun.

digit

The Winner of the 'Post your best Planet Digit Experience' contest is...

vickymustdie
Analogue Novice

Joined:
03 March 2004
Posts: 1
Location:
Mumbai

Posted: Mon Mar 15, 2004 3:06 pm **Post Subject:** Games as a career...

Hi guys, Almost everyone at the Digit Forum likes to play games. The only thing I wanna ask is: How many are seriously taking games as a career? How many are looking forward to develop one? There's a hell of a choice in this industry that one can choose from... such as cinematic artist, game tester, game designer, level designer, screenwriter, sound engineer, junior programmer, lead programmer, special effects programmer, audio programmer/engineer, artificial intelligence programmer, multiplayer networking programmer, 3D modeller, etc.

So, I request all you gamers to think of getting in the game industry.

crusader77
In-House Geek

Joined:
29 Dec 2003
Posts: 198

Posted: Wed Mar 17, 2004 10:03 am **Post Subject:**

What's sorely lacking in the Indian gaming industry are good 'ideas'. These kind of games have a very small audience and it will get nowhere by making these kinda games. Also, there aren't enough people seriously into this field (as a career) as compared to any other country. In the US and UK, there are full-fledged courses and diplomas in game development, designing, and programming. These also play a very important role as it's a very overwhelming task to start off especially in game programming, on your own. For example, trying to learn and master Direct-3D programming on your own, I know how difficult this is cause I am doing this on my own.

Goof Ups

■ The Intel 845GVSR motherboard featured in February 2004 on page 47, is based on the Intel 845 chipset and features Socket 478 as opposed to Socket A. The motherboard's documentation mentions that it is designed, especially for the Intel Celeron and so, we tested it using a 2.8 GHz Celeron, leading to a total score of 41.01. However, the motherboard also supports the 533 FSB Pentium 4. We re-tested it using a P4 3.06 GHz CPU, resulting in a total score of 47.22, which is approximately 15 per cent more than the previous one.

Notice any goof-ups?

Write to goof@jasubhai.com

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